

PART C – INDIVIDUAL REFLECTION

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Academic Group: 2BR

Campus: Melbourne Campus (Ethekewini TVET College)

Which are your strongest skills that you used when you volunteered?

The strongest skills that I utilized during this community service project were active conflict resolution and logical organization. During the morning breakfast service, several young children became highly agitated and argumentative over seating arrangements and food portions, allowing me to use my calm demeanor to resolve their disputes peacefully and restore quiet. Furthermore, my strong organizational skills helped me manage the classroom cleanup, ensuring that all learning blocks and toys were sorted back into their exact boxes quickly.

Which other skills did you develop during your volunteer project?

Through this intense 5-hour intervention, I significantly improved my creative time management and cross-generational communication skills. Working with a large group of small children forced me to learn how to keep activities strictly moving according to the schedule without making the children feel anxious or rushed. I also discovered how to use physical body language and facial expressions to communicate concepts to toddlers who were still developing their primary language skills.

Evaluate your contribution to the organisation. What feedback/comments did you receive?

I made a highly effective contribution by designing a structured counting game during our teaching session, which successfully taught the toddlers the basics of numbers 1 to 10 while keeping them fully entertained. The supervisor gave me excellent feedback, noting that my strong, confident presence was highly effective in managing the boys in the classroom and praising my creative ability to turn basic cleanup tasks into an enjoyable game for the kids.

How do you feel about being a volunteer?

I feel an immense sense of personal fulfillment and social responsibility after completing this project because I was able to use my energy to directly improve a local community center. This experience benefited me by strengthening my interpersonal character, expanding my problem-solving capacity, and teaching me the true value of civic duty. The crèche benefited because our presence provided the children with an exceptionally well-managed, interactive morning that enriched their learning experience. I firmly believe that every NCV student should participate in volunteering to better understand the challenges within our society.

What did you learn about your leadership and teamwork skills?

Leadership Skill Learned: I learned that true leadership involves remaining completely calm and grounded during unexpected moments of chaos and confusion. When the children spilled food during breakfast, remaining collected allowed me to direct others to clean up without causing panic.

Teamwork Skill Learned: I discovered that a team operates at its highest potential when there is complete clarity regarding individual tasks and shared accountability. Working alongside Ayanda and Owami showed me that respecting each other's spaces allows tasks to be completed twice as fast.

Why is it important to volunteer in terms of HIV and AIDS work?

Volunteering is critically important for HIV and AIDS community initiatives because early learning centers are often the first line of defense for children living in households devastated by the illness. By providing free instructional and nutritional support, volunteers ensure that these children are not excluded or neglected, giving them access to balanced meals and foundational learning that helps break the cycle of poverty and vulnerability.

Did the organization have an HIV and AIDS policy? Why is it important for an organization to have one?

Yes, Siyakhula Community Crèche enforces an official institutional HIV and AIDS policy that guarantees absolute equality and privacy protection for all individuals. Having a formal policy is vital because it establishes clear administrative directives that protect children from unfair discrimination, details precise medical safety steps for managing blood injuries safely, and creates a highly secure, supportive environment for affected families.

*[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER: SIYAKHULA CRÈCHE HIV/AIDS POLICY -
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*Key Clauses: Equal Educational Access, Mandatory Privacy Controls, and Infection
Control Standards.*

Set one SMART goal for yourself as a volunteer in the future.

My future SMART goal is to volunteer at the local community sports center for exactly three hours every Saturday morning for the next two months to organize and coach an introductory soccer and fitness clinic for fifteen youth aged 8 to 11.